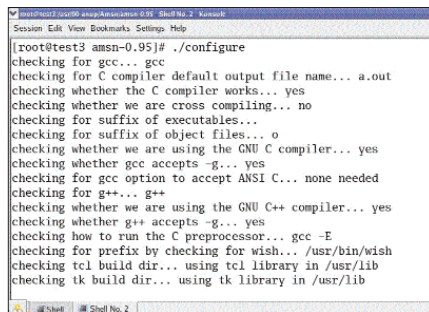


## Installing MSN Messenger

You can use Gaim, a multi-messenger, to connect to MSN messenger, but if you want to have a dedicated messenger that looks and feels more like Windows MSN messenger, you're probably looking for AMSN. You can download the installer from <http://amsn.sourceforge.net>. You may choose to download ready made installers depending on the distribution. We will tell you how to install it from a tarball. After you have downloaded the tarball, switch to the directory where you have saved it and untar/uncompress the files using the following command:

```
# tar -zxvf amsn-0.95.tar.gz
```

Now we have to configure aMSN by running its configure script; but always read the README or the INSTALL file before you proceed as it gives information of dependencies



```
Session Edit View Bookmarks Settings Help
[root@test3 amsn-0.95]# ./configure
checking for gcc... gcc
checking for C compiler default output file name... a.out
checking whether the C compiler works... yes
checking whether we are cross compiling... no
checking for suffix of executables...
checking for suffix of object files... o
checking whether we are using the GNU C compiler... yes
checking whether gcc accepts -g... yes
checking for gcc option to accept ANSI C... none needed
checking for g++... g++
checking whether we are using the GNU C++ compiler... yes
checking whether g++ accepts -g... yes
checking how to run the C preprocessor... gcc -E
checking for prefix by checking for wish... /usr/bin/wish
checking tcl build dir... using tcl library in /usr/lib
checking tk build dir... using tk library in /usr/lib
```

The list of commands that run when you're trying to install aMSN



```
aMSN Edit View Actions
To: http://whine.in <raaabo@raaabo.com>
[21:02:40] http://whine.in joins conversation
[21:03:12] anup says:
copy paste some rubbish
[21:03:59] http://whine.in says:
well i am really glad you decided to try out the linux version
of MSN
[21:04:02] http://whine.in says:
Digit - Your Technology Navigator
[21:04:27] anup says:
ha ha ... and i believe you!
Send
```

aMSN looks just like Windows' MSN Messenger

if any. You should have tcl-dev and tk-dev packages. Now, run the configure script by typing in

```
#./configure [Enter]
```

This script will check for all the dependent packages and create a Makefile for final installation based on the detected system configuration. On successful completion of configure, run the **#make** command. This will take some time; after that, finalise the installation with the command **#make install**. You can launch the messenger immediately by typing "amsn" at the shell prompt. Or reboot to find the link on Hat > Internet > aMSN.

Your Linux alternative for MSN messenger is as shown in figure 3.



### Using cdrecord

Most Linux distributions have an inbuilt command line CD burning tool called 'cdrecord'. Using this tool isn't as simple as it was in Redhat 9 shrike. A few things need to be configured before you can proceed with the steps to record a CD.

First, type in the command **cdrecord -scanbus** at the shell prompt; if the output shows your CD/DVD writer on 1,x,x or 2,x,x, then we have work on our hands. But if the output displays the drive on 0,x,x (ideally 0,0,0) then skip to the MKISOFS step. The steps involved:

1. Identifying your drive's device driver
2. Loading ide-scsi emulation
3. MKISOFS
4. CDRECORD for CD-R
5. CDRECORD for CD-RW

When identifying your drive's device driver, it is

advisable to use the CD/DVD-Writer as secondary master, be it Windows or Linux, or any OS for that matter. In our example, the DVD-Writer is connected as secondary master, and the device driver then becomes /dev/hdc. To know this without flirting with the hardware, type in "dmesg |grep -i CD" at the shell prompt. The output will be similar to: "Added public key 6ECDA687281A73E5 hdc: LITE-ON DVD-RW SHM-165P6S, ATAPI CD/DVD-ROM drive"



### Loading ide-scsi Emulation

IDE emulation is required for Fedora as the CD writers are loaded as scsi drive, and we need to emulate that to IDE manually (Users of Red Hat 9 or below do not need to do this). Just follow the following instructions:

Change to root user, and type in

```
/sbin/insmod -p ide-scsi
and hit [Enter].
```

if you get an error then we have to make a few changes in a few important files. First create a file under /etc named "modules.conf" if it doesn't already exist, and add the line:

```
"alias scsi_hostadapter
ide-scsi"
```

Save and close the file. Also, you can add the following command to /etc/rc.local so that it is executed at every boot:

```
"/sbin/insmod ide-scsi"
```

Now comes the critical part of the boot loader. Many people use grub, but some use lilo. Grub users should open the file /etc/grub.conf using the vi editor. Take the cursor to the line:

```
"kernel /vmlinuz-2.6.9-1.667 ro root=LABEL=/ rhgb
quiet"
```

And add "hdc=ide-scsi" at the end.

Lilo users should open "lilo.conf" located under /etc using the vi editor, or any

text editor of your preference, and add append="hdc=ide-scsi" to it. Note that hdc is the secondary master on the IDE cable that connects your CD/DVD drive to the motherboard of your system. Lastly, run lilo at the shell prompt to effect the changes.

Grub users need not run any command. Now reboot the system to initiate all changes. Login as root or switch to root using the "su" command and run

```
/sbin/insmod -p ide-scsi
```

to check if the settings have worked. You shouldn't get an error. Or try

```
#cdrecord -scanbus
```

The output should now show your CD/DVD drive on: 0,0,0 0) 'LITE-ON ' 'DVD-RW SHM-165P6S' 'MS0C' Removable CD-ROM

You have successfully loaded ide-scsi emulation!



### Using MKISOFS

To burn a disc using cdrecord command, we have to create ISO filesystem containing all the files you want on your CD. To make an ISO file:

```
#mkisofs -v -o
isofilename.iso file1 file2
file3... [Enter]
```

Or create a folder, say /tmp/Disc, and dump all the files you want to copy to a CD into this folder. Change the directory to Disc (here: /tmp/Disc) and then use the same command as:

```
#mkisofs -v -o
isofilename.iso * [Enter]
```

Even better, use:

```
#mkisofs -v -o
isofilename.iso -J -R /tm/Disc
and hit [Enter]
```

-J is for Joliet extension (for Windows support) and -R is for RockRidge extension. We now have a file (isofilename.iso) that contains all the files we want to write to a CD. Even